PRINTABLE CLUE CARDS

Christmas Morning Scavenger Hunt

24 clue cards in two levels, with a parent setup sheet and answer key

13 PAGES

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GM's Digital Creations

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How the Hunt Works

Ten minutes of setup the night before, and the kids follow the clues to their gift on Christmas morning.

Pick your level

Every hiding spot has two cards. Little Elves cards are short rhymes for early readers (about ages 4 to 7). Big Kid Riddle cards make older kids think (about ages 8 to 12). Mix levels if you have kids of different ages.

Set it up the night before

1. Print the cards on cardstock and cut along the dashed lines.
2. Choose a hunt length: 6 spots for little ones, 10 to 12 for most families, up to 24 for a long morning.
3. Plan the order on the Setup Sheet (page 3). Each card points to one spot; the spot code is in the corner.
4. Hand the kids the first card. Hide each next card at the spot the card before it describes.
5. Fill in the Final Gift card with where the gift is waiting and hide it at the last spot.

Tips from hosts

- [ ] Skip any spot your home does not have; the blank cards let you write your own.
- [ ] Hide cards so a corner peeks out for little ones.
- [ ] Give siblings different colours of cardstock so each follows a trail.
- [ ] Keep the answer key in your pocket for quick hints.

A sample 6-spot hunt for little ones (about 15 minutes)

CARD	WHERE THE CARD IS HIDDEN	IT POINTS THE KIDS TO
1	Hand it over at breakfast	S01 Christmas tree
2	Under the tree	S11 Couch cushions
3	Under a couch cushion	S06 Bookshelf
4	Between two books	S02 Refrigerator
5	Taped inside the fridge door	S13 Cereal box
6	Beside the cereal	S07 Your pillow
7	Under the pillow	Final Gift card

Prints on US Letter and A4 at 100% (actual size). Cardstock works best.

FOR GROWN-UPS

Setup Sheet and Answer Key

Write the hunt order in the first column. Card 1 goes to the kids; hide each next card at the spot the card before it points to.

ORDER	CODE	CARD POINTS TO	HIDE THE NEXT CARD HERE?
	S01	Christmas tree	
	S02	Refrigerator	
	S03	Bathtub	
	S04	Washing machine	
	S05	Front door	
	S06	Bookshelf	
	S07	Your pillow	
	S08	Sock drawer	
	S09	Shoes by the door	
	S10	Kitchen table	
	S11	Couch cushions	
	S12	TV	
	S13	Cereal box	
	S14	Bathroom mirror	
	S15	Toy box	
	S16	Coat pocket	
	S17	Laundry basket	
	S18	Pantry	
	S19	Christmas stockings	
	S20	A window	
	S21	Bath towel	
	S22	A lamp	
	S23	Spoon drawer	
	S24	Your backpack	

Little Elves Clues

Easy rhymes for early readers, spots 1 to 6

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

I am green and I glow. Look under me, down low!

S01

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

It is cold inside, with milk and cheese. Open the door and look, please!

S02

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Splish and splash, it is time to scrub. Run and look in the big bathtub!

S03

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Your socks go round and round in me. Look in the washer and you will see!

S04

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Knock, knock! Who is there? Look by the front door, over there!

S05

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

I hold the books, big and small. Look on the shelf by the wall!

S06

Little Elves Clues

Easy rhymes for early readers, spots 7 to 12

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Sleep tight, sleepy head. Look under the pillow on your bed!

S07

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Socks for the left and socks for the right. Look in the sock drawer, hidden from sight!

S08

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Left foot, right foot, step in a pair. Look in a shoe. Is a clue in there?

S09

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

We eat and play games over here. Look under the table, the clue is near!

S10

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Sit on the couch, so soft and plump. Look under a cushion, then jump, jump, jump!

S11

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Shows and cartoons, movies too. Look by the TV for your clue!

S12

Little Elves Clues

Easy rhymes for early readers, spots 13 to 18

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Crunch and munch, a breakfast treat. Look by the cereal you like to eat!

S13

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Who is that? It looks like you! Look by the mirror for your clue.

S14

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Blocks and balls and dolls galore. Look in the toy box, then find more!

S15

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Zip up your coat when it is cold out. Check a coat pocket, look all about!

S16

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Dirty clothes go in a heap. Look in the laundry basket, take a peek!

S17

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Snacks and soup and a jar of jam. Look in the pantry as fast as you can!

S18

Little Elves Clues

Easy rhymes for early readers, spots 19 to 24

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Big red socks hang in a row. Look in your stocking, ho ho ho!

S19

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Look outside. Is it snowing? Check by a window and keep on going!

S20

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

After a bath, you dry off with me. Look by a towel and you will see!

S21

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Click! Now it is bright. Look by a lamp that gives us light!

S22

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Forks and spoons go clink, clink, clink. Look in the drawer close to the sink!

S23

LITTLE ELVES CLUE CLUE NO. ____

Books and lunch go in me for school. Look in your backpack, that would be cool!

S24

Big Kid Riddles

Tricky riddles for older kids, spots 1 to 6

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I stand in the room with a star on my head. I wear lights and bows, but I never go to bed.

S01

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I hum all day and keep winter inside. Open my door where the leftovers hide.

S02

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I fill up with water but never take a drink. I am much bigger than the bathroom sink.

S03

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I spin your clothes like a ride at the fair, then give them back clean and ready to wear.

S04

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

Guests and the mail carrier know me well. Some people knock and some ring my bell.

S05

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I hold many stories, but I cannot read. Look between my books for the clue that you need.

S06

Big Kid Riddles

Tricky riddles for older kids, spots 7 to 12

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

Every night you rest your head on me. Lift me up and your next clue you will see.

S07

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I am full of pairs, but one always goes missing. Pull me open and keep the hunt going.

S08

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I have a tongue but I cannot talk, and I go with you everywhere you walk.

S09

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I have four legs, but I never walk. Families sit around me to eat and to talk.

S10

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I am soft and comfy and I hold the whole crew. Check under my cushions to find your next clue.

S11

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I tell you stories, but I am not a book. Check near my screen and take a good look.

S12

Big Kid Riddles

Tricky riddles for older kids, spots 13 to 18

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I am poured in a bowl at the start of the day. Check by my box before you go play.

S13

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I copy each funny face that you make at me. Check by me in the bathroom and see.

S14

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I am full of fun, but I never play. Look where the toys get tidied away.

S15

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I hang in the closet and wait for the snow. Check in my pockets before you go.

S16

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

Worn clothes jump in me at the end of the day. Dig to my bottom, then be on your way.

S17

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I keep the food that does not need the cold. Open my door for snacks new and old.

S18

Big Kid Riddles

Tricky riddles for older kids, spots 19 to 24

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I am a sock much too big for a foot. Check me where the family stockings are put.

S19

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

You can see right through me, but I keep out the cold. Look by my sill for the next clue to hold.

S20

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

The more that I dry, the wetter I get. Look where I hang, you have not found it yet.

S21

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

When the sun goes down, I take its place. Look near my shade to keep up the chase.

S22

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I hold forks and spoons all lined up in a row. Pull me open, and then off you go.

S23

BIG KID RIDDLE CLUE NO. ____

I ride on your back to school and then back. Unzip me to find the next clue in the pack.

S24

BLANK CARDS

Write Your Own Clues

Add a spot only your home has: the garage, the dog's bed, Grandma's chair

WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE CLUE NO. ____

S__

WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE CLUE NO. ____

S__

WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE CLUE NO. ____

S__

WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE CLUE NO. ____

S__

WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE CLUE NO. ____

S__

WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE CLUE NO. ____

S__

THE BIG FINISH

Final Gift Cards

Hide one at the last spot of each trail

FINAL CARD

You did it!

Your Christmas gift is waiting at:

Merry Christmas!

FINAL CARD

You did it!

Your Christmas gift is waiting at:

Merry Christmas!

FINAL CARD

You did it!

Your Christmas gift is waiting at:

Merry Christmas!

FINAL CARD

You did it!

Your Christmas gift is waiting at:

Merry Christmas!

FINAL CARD

You did it!

Your Christmas gift is waiting at:

Merry Christmas!

FINAL CARD

You did it!

Your Christmas gift is waiting at:

Merry Christmas!

You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations